

A filesystem is just an array of bytes.

How do we store data in it?

↳ Let's divide the filesystem into chunks.



we call these chunks "blocks".

How big are the blocks? → 1 KB / 4 KB sound good.



4096 bytes

If we store a file in the fs, it may take up one or more blocks.

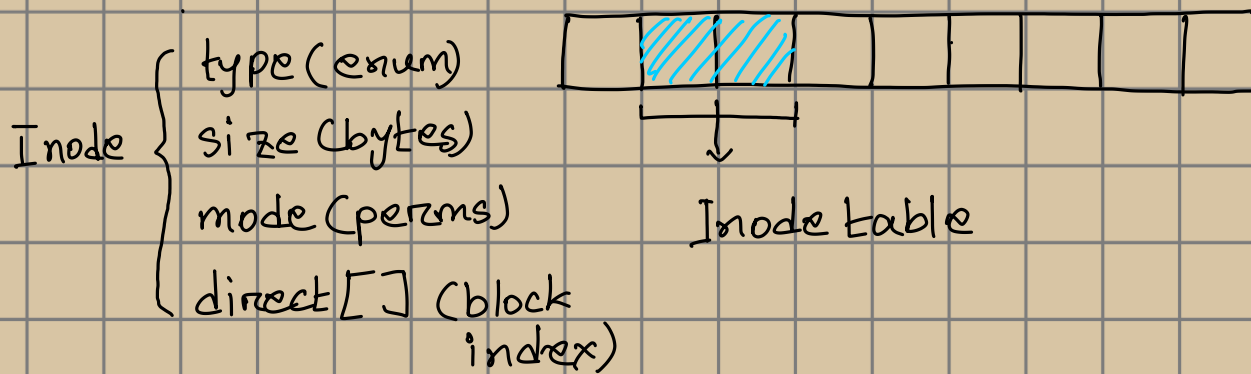
If a file takes up a block partially, we cannot put data of another file in it.



taken both are for a single file.

A file can take up contiguous or non-contiguous blocks. Thus, we need to know which blocks a file takes up, and in what order.

We use a structure that has the list of block indices for every file. We call this an "inode!"



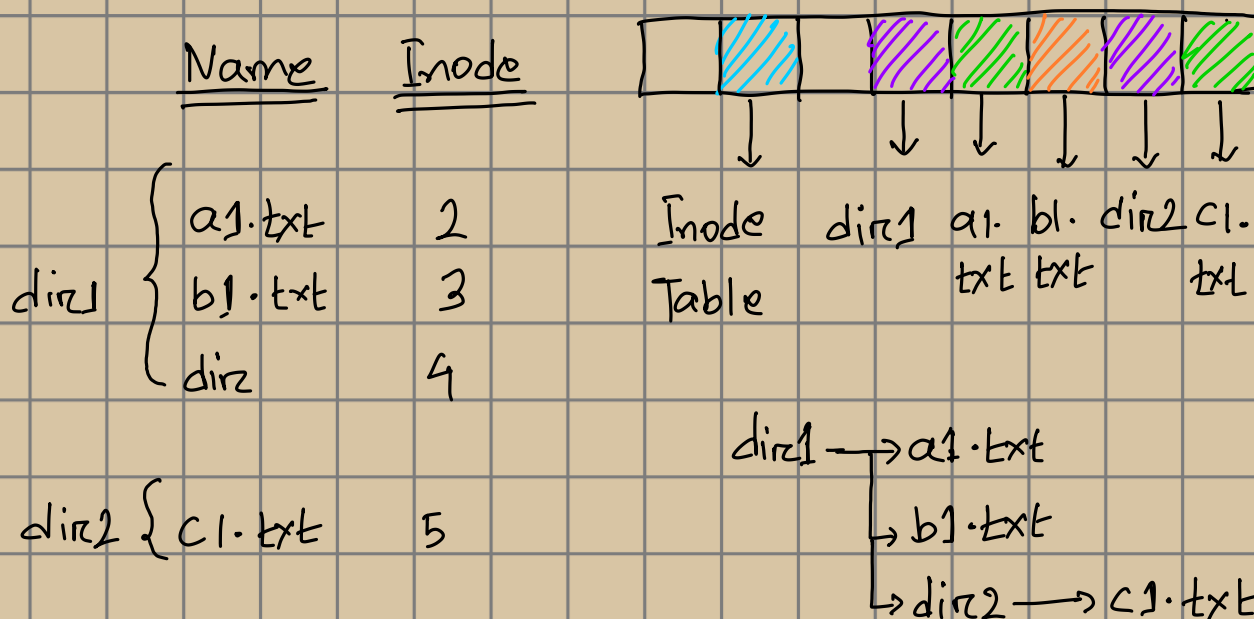
The direct[] array might not hold enough block indices.

We use another pointer that points to a block that holds more data block indices.

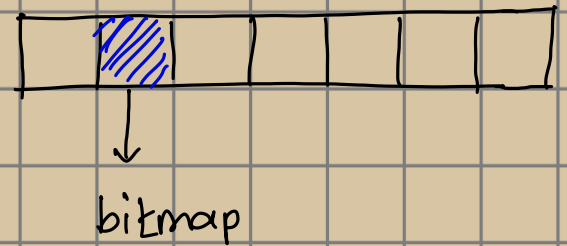
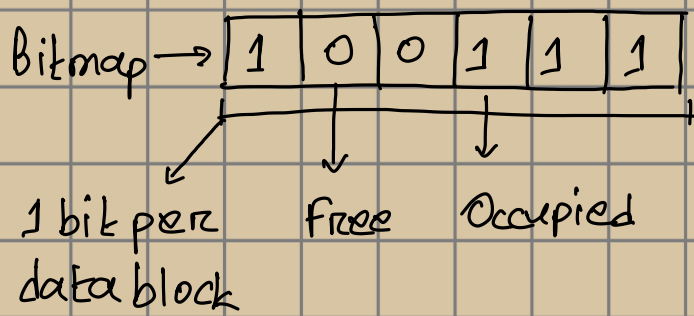
We might even have pointers to a block full of pointers that point to data blocks.

How do we store filenames and directories?

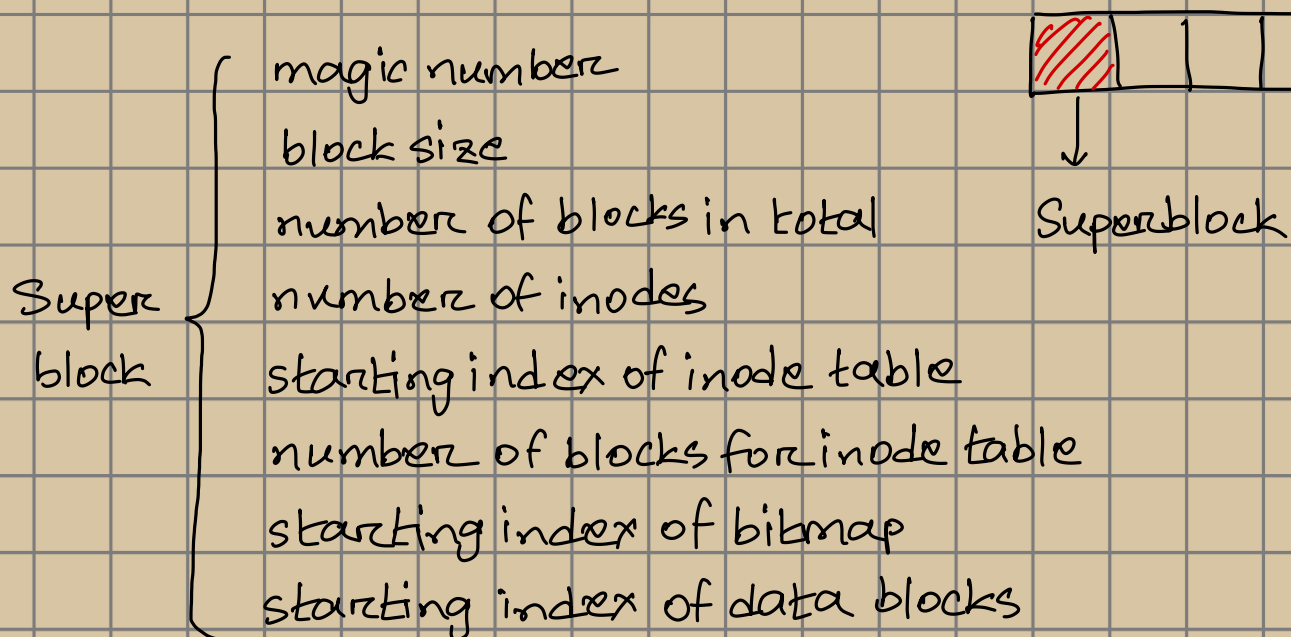
↳ Directories are also just files that hold filenames and inode numbers for those files.



Files grow. So, we need to store which bytes are free.
We can use a "bitmap" to do that.



We also need to store all the properties of the fs in a dedicated block. Let's put it in index 0, and call it a "Superblock." Let's also add a "magic number" in front of the superblock, to know that it is properly formatted.



Thus, the proposed layout:

